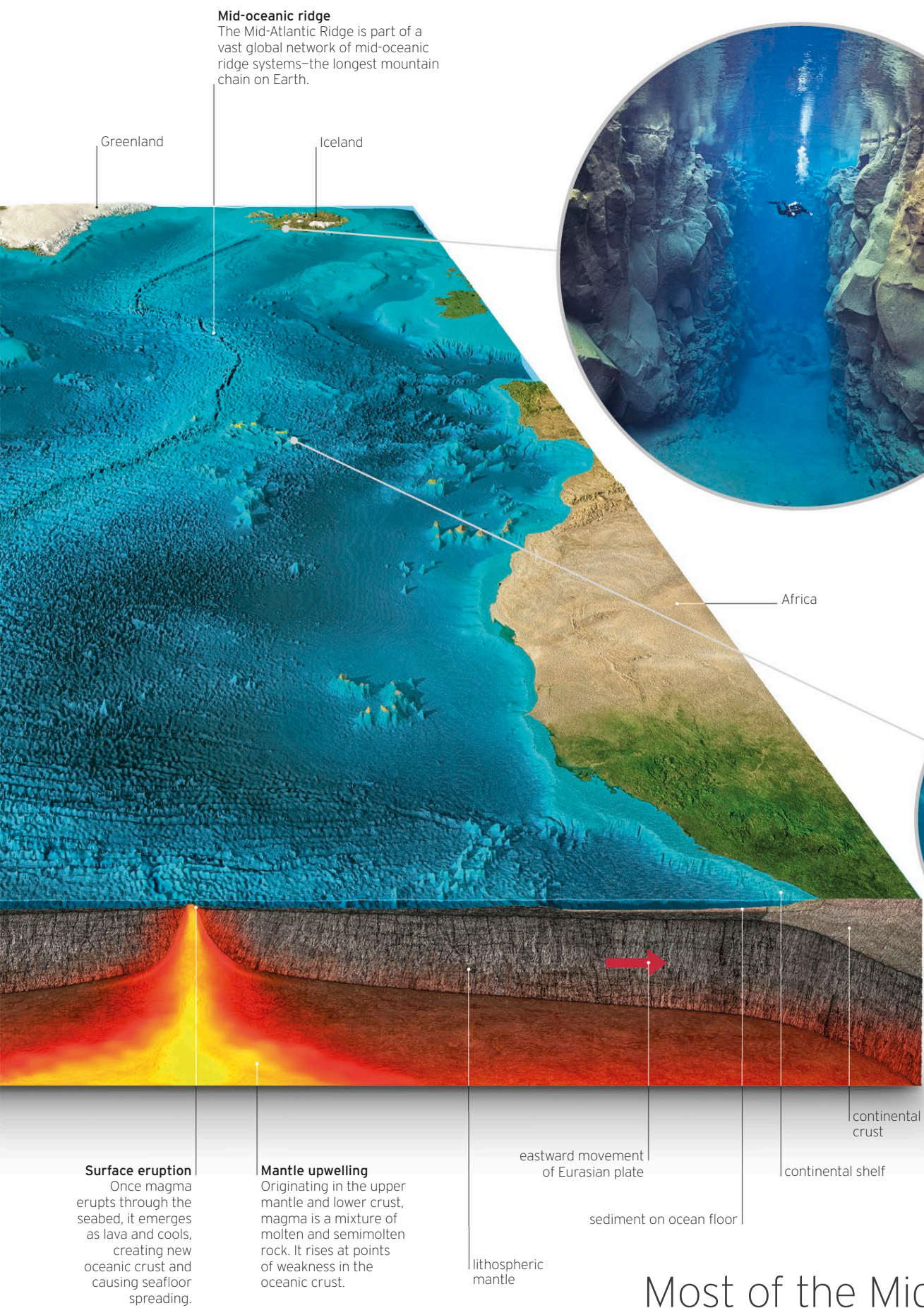




◁ **FRESHWATER FISSURE**

Iceland was formed by hotspot activity (see p.318) merging with the Mid-Atlantic Ridge. Further ridge spreading created a deep fissure, known as Silfra, at the bottom of Thingvellir Valley. Silfra is spring-fed with pure glacial meltwater, providing clear visibility for divers as they swim between the North American and Eurasian tectonic plates.

△ **ISLAND CHAIN**

The Azores are an example of an island chain formed by a combination of hotspot (see p.318) and ridge activity. When a hotspot occurs near a mid-oceanic ridge, the ridge segments nearest the hotspot are exposed to larger volumes of magma, leading to greater volcanic activity in the area.

Most of the Mid-Atlantic Ridge's **central rift valley** is **deeper and wider** than the **Grand Canyon**